Chen Gao

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Current Position

Research Assistant Sep 2026 – Present
Centre for Macroeconomics *London, UK*
London School of Economics and Political Science
Supervisors: Jonathon Hazell, Benjamin Moll, and Ricardo Reis

Education

Peking University Beijing, China
B.A. in Economics with Honors and Distinction *Sep 2022 – Jun 2026*
- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.873/4.0
- **Selected Honors:** Outstanding Graduate (2026), Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis (2026), Ho-Mou Wu Memorial Scholarship (2026).
- **Selected Coursework:** Computational Economics (Graduate Level, 4.0/4.0), Theory of Dynamic Optimization; Advanced Mathematics I (3.95/4.0), II (4.0/4.0), Linear Algebra, Probability Theory (3.95/4.0), Mathematical Statistics (3.95/4.0).

University of California, Berkeley Berkeley, CA
Visiting Undergraduate *Jan 2025 – May 2025*
- **Cumulative GPA:** 4.0/4.0
- **Selected Coursework:** Advanced Macroeconomics (Graduate Level, A+), Real Analysis (A), Numerical Analysis I & II (A).

Working Papers

Forecasting Inflation with Microdata: An Adaptive Machine Learning Approach

With Catherine Chen, Jonathon Hazell, Lihua Lei, and Chen Lian. Paper

Micro-price data improve UK inflation forecasts relative to a univariate benchmark in the volatile period after 2020.

Research Experience

Research Assistant Apr 2025 – Jun 2026
PI: Chen Lian *Berkeley, CA*
- **Project: "Why do Workers Dislike Inflation? Wage Erosion and Conflict Costs"**
  - Designed and implemented numerical solvers for the general equilibrium extension with endogenous wages and employment.
  - Refactored and documented the Python replication package to improve readability and reproducibility.
- Reviewed mathematical derivations and edited research manuscripts on inflation, misallocation, fiscal policy, and household beliefs.

Research Assistant Mar 2025 – Jun 2025
PI: Serguei Maliar *Santa Clara, CA*
- **Project: "Using Reinforcement Learning to Solve Heterogeneous Agent Models"**
  - Implemented K-nearest neighbors (KNN) reinforcement learning algorithms in Python to solve the Krusell-Smith heterogeneous-agent model.

Teaching Experience

Computational Economics (Graduate Level) Spring 2026
Instructor: Bo Li, School of Economics, Peking University *Beijing, China*
- Taught numerical methods for solving macroeconomic models in Python with JAX.
- Prepared lecture slides and delivered in-class sessions.

Intermediate Macroeconomics (Honors) Fall 2024
Instructor: Bo Zhao, National School of Development, Peking University *Beijing, China*
- Led weekly discussion sections and supplemented lecture notes.
- Co-authored the midterm and final exams and graded problem sets.

Skills

- **Scientific Computing:** Python (JAX, Numba), Fortran (OpenMP), MATLAB, Julia, Stata, C++
- **Markup Languages:** LaTeX, Typst
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent)